

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 4
 ♥ Q J 9 8
 ♦ J 8 6 2
 ♣ 8 7 2

♠ 10 9 5 3

♥ A K 4

♦ A Q 7

♣ K 6 3



♠ K J 8 7 2

♥ 10 7 5

♦ 10 9 4

♣ A 5

♠ A 6

♥ 6 3 2

♦ K 5 3

♣ Q J 10 9 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Think what West will do if you duck in dummy. He will play his honor, win the trick, and clear the suit by leading his small x. If East can get in with the ♣A he will run the ♠s.

But what will West do if you play dummy's ♠A? If he plays his small one the ♠ suit will block. If he unblocks his honor card then your ♠ 10 9 5 3 will provide a second stopper in the suit. So you go up with dummy's ♠A and guarantee the contract.

A tough finish that needs some real visualization to get right.

Of course from now on you will recognize it.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠7.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=3 ♣=0 Total = 6

It's pretty clear that your extra tricks are going to have to come from the ♣ suit. The danger here is that East may have a 5-card ♠ suit that he can establish and the ♣A as an entry. So what is the best approach, hold up or not hold up?

To answer that question you must think about East's lead. Since he did not lead the ♠K you know he doesn't have a suit headed by K Q J. So you can visualize West sitting there with a doubleton honor in ♠s. It might be ♠ K x, ♠ Q x or ♠ J x, but it is surely one of those three.